

ONBRD-99: Best Practice Summary

Series: ONBRD — Dynatrace Onboarding | **Reference:** 99 — Best Practice Summary | **Created:** March 2026 | **Last Updated:** 10/02/2026

Overview

Reference card for an architect or tenant lead onboarding a new 2026 Dynatrace tenant: recommended defaults, the key decision matrix, validation queries, anti-patterns, and the cross-series next-steps map.

For the **sequence + dependencies + per-step decisions**, see **ONBRD-00: Architect's Sequence & Dependency Runbook**.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Audience	Architect or tenant lead onboarding a new 2026 Dynatrace tenant

Requirement	Details
Used alongside	ONBRD-00: Architect's Sequence & Dependency Runbook for sequence + dependencies

1. Recommended Defaults (2026)

A new 2026 tenant should default to these choices unless there is a specific reason not to.

Area	Default	Why
API token	Platform Token (dt0s16) with Authorization: Bearer	Latest environments have platform tokens only: "Classic access tokens don't exist in latest environments, and v2/apiTokens isn't available." Classic access tokens (dt0c01 , Authorization: Api-Token) exist only in Classic and hybrid environments.
Configuration	Settings v2 / Configuration as Code (Terraform dynatrace_settings , Monaco v2)	SaaS 1.337: "Many Configuration API endpoints are now covered by the Settings endpoints in the Environment API v2." The affected Configuration API endpoints are deprecated. Plan automation around Settings v2.
Extensions	Extensions 2.0	Current extensions framework; EF1.0 end of support 2025-03-31. JMX and PMI EF1 extensions were kept past that date but are deprecated: "As of July 1, 2027, all Extension Framework 1.0 JMX and PMI extensions will be out of support for SaaS Environments." Migrate them during onboarding.

Area	Default	Why
Tagging at source	Primary fields/tags at OneAgent install via <code>oneagentctl --set-host-tag="primary_tags.<key>=<value>"</code> and <code>--set-host-tag="dt.security_context=<value>"</code> (single tags-hub form, June 2026; prefix written explicitly)	OneAgent attribute enrichment (OneAgent 1.333+) emits these on every signal at ingest.
Boundary field	<code>dt.security_context</code> for data + IAM scoping	Gen3 standard; segments + this field replace legacy Management Zones.
IAM policies	Parameterized policies bound to groups via binding parameters	Avoids N-copies-of-similar-policy maintenance burden.
K8s deployment	Dynatrace Operator + Cloud Native FullStack	<i>"Classic Full-Stack mode is not supported when using a platform token"</i> , the default credential above; ONBRD-05 covers the mode choice.
K8s CRD baseline	DynaKube <code>v1beta6</code> for new DynaKubes	Operator 1.11.0 removes <code>v1beta4</code> and says <i>"Before upgrading, update all DynaKube manifests to v1beta6."</i> <code>v1beta5</code> is still served by 1.11.0 but marked deprecated in its CRD (ONBRD-05).
Alerting	Workflows (simple workflows for notification) + custom alerts for metric conditions	Alerting profiles and problem notifications are Dynatrace Classic: <i>"They continue to work and are not being removed on a published schedule, but they'll not receive new capabilities."</i> Build new alerting on workflows (ONBRD-09).
Logs	OpenPipeline	The Latest Dynatrace path for log processing; OPMIG covers moving off classic log processing, OPLOGS the pipelines themselves.

Area	Default	Why
Windows OneAgent	Npcap for network insight (OneAgent 1.337+)	Required for Network Agent metrics; WinPcap is no longer supported.

Sources:

- [Authentication \(DT docs\)](#) — "dtOs16 Platform Token enabling programmatic access to Dynatrace platform services."; [Upgrade from classic access tokens \(DT docs\)](#)
- [SaaS 1.337 \(DT docs\)](#)
- [EF1 JMX and PMI extensions end of support \(DT docs\)](#); [End-of-support news \(DT docs\)](#) — "Note that JMX and PMI Extensions Framework 1.0 are supported past March 2025 but are deprecated."
- [Classic Full-Stack monitoring \(DT docs\)](#); [Operator 1.11.0 release notes \(DT docs\)](#); `v1beta5 deprecated: true` read from the DynaKube CRD in the Operator v1.11.0 `kubernetes.yaml` ([Operator releases \(Dynatrace GitHub\)](#)), 10/02/2026
- [Upgrade guide: alert notifications \(DT docs\)](#)

2. Decision Matrix

Decisions an architect makes during onboarding, with default and when to deviate.

Decision	Default	When to deviate
ActiveGate yes/no	Recommended if >500 hosts (ONBRD-03); needed for hybrid/on-prem or cloud-API polling at scale	Pure SaaS-only with no on-prem footprint can defer until cloud-API polling demands it
ActiveGate sizing	10–20 GB disk per ActiveGate (ONBRD-03); CPU and memory per FAQ-10; 2–3 AGs per network zone	Larger only when load testing shows it is needed
Per-cloud integration	Clouds app for AWS (GA) and Azure (SaaS 1.337+, no AG for metric polling); GCP Clouds-app connection in Preview — verify it has reached your tenant; the classic AG-based GCP integration remains the working path until then	If existing CloudWatch / Azure Monitor pipelines exist, evaluate migration effort vs leaving in place

Decision	Default	When to deviate
OneAgent rollout sequence	Pilot 2–5 non-critical hosts (ONBRD-05) → expand by host group → full	Skip pilot if you have onboarded the same workload class on another tenant
Tag taxonomy	env / team / app / dt.security_context / dt.cost.costcenter	Add compliance dimensions (*-pci , *-pii) only if a hard audit boundary exists
Host group naming	<env>-<app> or <env>-<workload-type> per FAQ-01	Customer-specific patterns acceptable; avoid all-hosts / default / hardware-trait names
Bucket strategy	dt.security_context for general data access; buckets only for compliance / retention / hard cost / hostile multi-tenancy	See ORGNZ-02 (Grail buckets) and ORGNZ-99 for the buckets-vs- dt.security_context decision
OTel coexistence	OneAgent for instrumentation; OTel for app-code spans / business events / serverless	Per FAQ-03 OneAgent vs OpenTelemetry decision framework
Workflow trigger	Problem trigger (default); Event trigger with a DQL filter (advanced)	Custom DQL triggers when business-event-driven alerting is required
Dashboard tier	Operations + Executive (mandatory); Engineering (recommended)	Skip Executive if there is no exec stakeholder for this tenant
Notification channel for new tenant	Slack / email / PagerDuty silent channel for first 1–2 weeks	Switch to live channels only after dual-alert window validates volume parity

3. Validation Queries

A small DQL set that verifies each phase complete. Save these as a notebook in the new tenant — they are the architect's smoke-test for the deployment.

Phase 1 — Foundation complete

Hosts reporting (Gate G1):

```
// Hosts reporting (Gate G1 – Foundation -&gt; Organize)
smartscapeNodes "HOST"
| summarize host_count = count()

// Caveat: Smartscape HOST nodes can leave out PaaS-only hosts. On a
validation tenant
// (10/02/2026) this returned 7 while fetch dt.entity.host returned 15; the 8
missing were
// Kubernetes application-only and AWS Fargate hosts (paasVendorType
KUBERNETES /
// AWS_ECS_FARGATE). For those rollouts, count with the classic entity
instead:
//   fetch dt.entity.host
//   | summarize host_count = count(), by: {paasVendorType}
```

```
// Services discovered
smartscapeNodes "SERVICE"
| summarize service_count = count()
```

Phase 2 — Organize complete

Primary fields propagating; `dt.security_context` populated (Gate G2):

```
// dt.security_context populated on logs (Gate G2 – Organize -&gt; Operate)
fetch logs, from:-1h
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{dt.security_context}
| sort c desc
```

```
// Primary tags propagating
fetch logs, from:-1h
| filter isNotNull(primary_tags.environment)
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{primary_tags.environment}
```

Phase 3 — Operate complete

Davis surfacing problems, and workflows running:

```
// Davis problems detected (last 7 days)
fetch dt.davis.problems, from:-7d
| summarize { c = count() }, by:{event.status}
```

```
// Workflow runs by final state (last 7 days)
// Each run also writes a RUNNING record when it starts; filter to final
states to count runs once
fetch dt.system.events, from:-7d
| filter event.kind == "WORKFLOW_EVENT" and event.type == "WORKFLOW_EXECUTION"
| filter in(dt.automation_engine.state, {"SUCCESS", "ERROR"})
| summarize { runs = count() }, by:{dt.automation_engine.workflow.title,
dt.automation_engine.state}
| sort runs desc
```

4. Anti-Patterns to Avoid

Anti-pattern	Why it bites later
Single host group (<code>all-hosts</code> / <code>default</code>)	Per-host-group thresholds, alerting profiles, and IAM policies become impossible to scope
Setting tags retroactively (after install)	Primary-tag-at-install propagation gets skipped; signals before the retroactive setting do not carry the tag
Many copies of similar IAM policies (one per group with hardcoded scope)	Maintenance grows with org churn; use parameterized policies bound via binding parameters
Legacy Management Zones for new tenant	API 1.337 marks the <code>managementZone</code> (and <code>serviceTag</code>) properties of calculated service metrics deprecated; segments + <code>dt.security_context</code> + policies are the Latest Dynatrace path (MZ2POL)
Auto-tagging rules as the primary tagging strategy	Applied to entities by periodic background rule evaluation, which can lag (<i>"the application of all tags might be delayed!"</i>), not written onto records at ingest; doesn't propagate to logs / business events uniformly
<code>fetch dt.entity.*</code> queries in new content	Modern path is <code>smartscapeNodes "<TYPE>" ; dt.entity.*</code> works but is deprecated

Anti-pattern	Why it bites later
Buckets used as the primary access-control mechanism	Buckets are for compliance / retention / hard cost / hostile multi-tenancy; default for general data access is <code>dt.security_context</code>
Classic FullStack on Kubernetes	Not supported with platform tokens; use Cloud Native FullStack
Configuration API for new automation	Many Configuration API endpoints are deprecated in favour of Settings (SaaS 1.337); plan new pipelines on Settings v2 / Terraform / Monaco v2
Naming host groups by hardware traits (<code>4cpu-hosts</code> , <code>region-only</code>)	Encodes properties that change; rename burden as workloads scale

Sources: [Dynatrace API 1.337 \(DT docs\)](#) — `POST /calculatedMetrics/service : "Changed property managementZone Deprecated changed to true"`; [Settings API: automatically applied tags schema \(DT docs\)](#) — `"Tagging rules are executed periodically in the background, for a limited timeframe."`; [Classic Full-Stack monitoring \(DT docs\)](#); [SaaS 1.337 \(DT docs\)](#).

5. Where to Go Deeper — Topic Series Map

ONBRD covers the foundation. These topic series cover each domain in depth:

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
IAM administration	IAM	15
Data organization (buckets, segments, security context)	ORGNZ	11
Frequently asked questions	FAQ	growing collection
OpenPipeline log processing	OPLOGS	9
Classic Logs → OpenPipeline migration	OPMIG	10

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
OpenPipeline beyond logs (spans, metrics, events, bizevents)	OPIPE	7
Distributed tracing & spans	SPANS	9
Kubernetes monitoring & DynaKube	K8S	15
Cloud integration deep dives (AWS, Azure, GCP)	CLOUD	9
OpenTelemetry integration	OTEL	9
Workflows & alert notifications	WFLOW	12
Alerting strategy & design	ALERT	5
Service level objectives	SLO	6
Dynatrace Intelligence (Causal/Predictive/Generative AI, Davis)	AIOPS	8
Dashboard strategy & executive reporting	DASH	8
Configuration automation & GitOps	AUTOM	14
Management Zone → Policy migration	MZ2POL	11
Web Real User Monitoring	WEBRUM	10
Native mobile monitoring	MOBL	13
Synthetic monitoring	SYNTH	7
Business events & funnel analytics	BIZEV	8
Database monitoring	DBMON	7
Application security	APPSEC	10
Cost management & FinOps	FINOPS	3
Platform maturity & adoption roadmap	ADOPT	7
Managed → SaaS migration	M2S	11
SaaS → SaaS migration	S2S	12
New Relic → Dynatrace (procedural runbook)	NR2DT	11

Domain	Topic Series	Notebooks
New Relic → Dynatrace (component deep dives)	NRLC	9
Sumo Logic → Dynatrace	SL2DT	11
Splunk → Dynatrace	S2D	10

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against the current [Dynatrace documentation](#).